their areas' after which police and army rescue missions were coordinated.[20] The organized nature of evacuation had one flipside: it also led to organized violence with easier identification of the refugee movements for the attackers.

The refugee camps that the displaced encountered after their 'last journey' across the border were run by an assortment of charitable organizations. The radio broadcast in the camps every night was a significant event as it would relay news on the people missing, dead or found elsewhere.[21] With people huddled into refugee camps or homes of their friends and relatives, an even more daunting task of rehabilitation awaited the policymakers. India's first Union government had set up a dedicated ministry of relief and rehabilitation to tackle these challenges. The nature of the challenges can be surmised by the fact that the ministry was disbanded only four decades later in 1984.[22] K.C. Neogy (1888–1970) from West Bengal headed the first ministry and outlined a vision of rehabilitation closely tied up with broader goals of national development. Rehabilitation work included the building of new townships from scratch, repatriation of movable property, re-use or disposal of vacant immovable property, and much more, for millions of people. Official categories of the displaced included agriculturists and townspeople, traders and artisans, orphaned or unclaimed children, widows, or abducted or destitute women, and each had their own requirements. A series of legislations, agreements, treaties and financial assistance measures were passed to cater to people's needs, culminating in the Displaced Persons (Compensation and Rehabilitation) Act of 1954.

The most spectacular success in rehabilitation was achieved in agricultural resettlement. Two decades before Punjab's much-touted Green Revolution of the late 1960s and '1970s, vast lands lay uncultivated with no clear titles due to Partition-related displacement. Tarlok Singh (1913–2005), an economist trained at the London School of Economics and member of the Indian Civil Services (ICS), was the director-general of rehabilitation in east Punjab and rose to the occasion along with thousands of revenue officials in resolving a complicated problem.[23] The first step of resettlement